

Pornography

The Silent Killer of Marriages

About ten years ago, I was invited to give a Pro-life talk to married couples in a Parish and among the topics I addressed was pornography. Before I discussed the effects of pornography on marriages, **one woman shared in tears how her husband's addiction to pornography led to their separation. "I could no longer stand his sexual demands! They were outrageous! They drove me crazy!" she said while sobbing.** We all became emotional; it was not easy to listen to her story. She is one of the many men and women suffering silently.

"Adult videos" is what they are commonly called to make us think it is okay for adults to watch them. Some leaders of married couples have erroneously recommended them for couples preparing for marriage. However, it should be noted that pornography consumption according to the teaching of the Catholic Church is a grave sin against chastity (CCC 2354). This means that if I watch pornography without being forced yet I know that it is a grave sin, I commit a mortal sin.

Pornography can have devastating effects on marriages. Here are some effects of pornography on marriage.

Sexual dissatisfaction

Consumption of pornography is very addictive; when a person becomes an addict, they will witness certain changes in their daily life. They would become sexually dissatisfied, even after having the best sex.

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Despite their disapproval, they would find themselves inclined towards recreating pornography activities with their partner. Once bored with one set of pornography, they would move towards the extreme ones, and the urge to experience that would arise, eventually putting them in danger. An addict's world will revolve around pornography only; other things will hold no value or importance, not even marriage. They often times view their spouses as sex objects and disrespect them.

Unrealistic expectations

As mentioned above, one of the effects of pornography on marriage is that it creates an illusionary world for the addict. Initially, pornography effects might not be prominent, but gradually, they would look for opportunities to create a world of their own.

They would want to have everything that's been shown or done there. They won't hesitate to take a risk with their life or even with their existing relationship. They are ready to put everything on edge just to have the satisfaction and happiness they will derive from it.

Pornography leads to infidelity

Watching different people sleeping with different partners in pornographic videos corrupts the

mind of the consumer and it starts believing that it is okay to sleep with anyone. It can corrupt the mind to the level of practicing incest, bestiality, homosexuality, rape and defilement. They have constant lust and think everyone wants to have sex all the time.

Controlling this urge becomes more and more difficult as their addiction gets worse.

Relationship Quality:

Research indicates that pornography use is one of the strongest predictors of poor relationship quality and stability, leading to difficulties in relationships

Decreased Intimacy:

Some people think that Pornography consumption improves intimacy yet on the contrary, it often results in decreased intimacy, challenges with communication, and unrealistic expectations regarding sexual performance. A married couple should not have pornography actors as their teachers of intimacy since they are not in love, do not have any sacramental union, 75% are on drugs and they are doing this purely for money or are forced to do it. There is nothing in common with married couples.